AWT MATCH RULES & PROCEDURES 2025

OUR MISSION

TO PROMOTE
REWARDING MANUFACTURING
CAREERS FOR THE FUTURE OF OUR COMMUNITIES

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1. BOT LOAD & ACTIVATION

1.1. SAFETY TESTING

1.1.1. All robots must pass a functional and safety test before being able to compete in the competition.

1.2. MATCH WEIGH-IN

1.2.1. All robots for each weight class must be at or under their respective weight limits before each match.

1.3. ENTERING THE ARENA

1.3.1. Robots with their weapon lock(s) installed and safety covers will be carried and held by each team until a referee directs the team that it's their turn to enter the arena. Teams may not enter their robot into the arena until directed by the referee.

1.4. ROBOT PLACEMENT

1.4.1. All robots will be placed in their respective starting point, "corner or square." Students will be directed to which corner they are to place their team's robot by the referee.

1.5. ROBOT ACTIVATION STEPS

1.5.1. The transmitter/ radio controller will be turned on by a student when the referee directs the team, and their robot may enter the arena. The transmitter must be carefully and clearly held away from the person's body so that no accidental or intentional movement from the robot could happen. This must be clearly shown to the referee.

1.5.1.1. For JuniorBots, only the Coach or Adviser may hold the transmitter for their School's team.

1.5.2. One teammate enters the combat arena with the referee, and the bot is placed in a stable position in its designated starting point.

1.5.3. Safety covers will be removed from the robot.

1.5.4. The main power is turned on at the direction of the referee.

1.5.5. Weapon locks are removed if there is no movement from the bot when the main power is turned on.

1.5.6. No movement or functional testing is permitted while anyone is in the combat area. If any team violates this rule, then the referee has the discretion to disqualify the offending team.

2.MATCH RULES

2.1. MOVEMENT CHECK

2.1.1. Once all robots are entered in the arena and the arena door is closed, the referee will ask each team to check that their robot can move and function properly. Weapon systems may also be briefly turned on to check functionality, but must be turned off (stop movement) before the match begins.

2.1.2. The Referee will ask if both teams are ready to start the match. If both teams say "yes," the referee continues to start the match. If a team says they don't have movement, the referee has the discretion to ask the opposing team to hold up their controllers, open the arena, and allow the team to "fix" or "re-activate" their robot. If this does not fix the problem, the team must forfeit the match.

2.2. MATCH TIME & START

2.2.1. A time limit will be placed on the clock, see Competition Guidelines 2.1. The match will then start at the direction of the Referee or Announcer.

2.3. FALSE STARTS

2.3.1. Before the match has officially started, robots are not permitted to move or activate their weapon. All movement must start once the match has officially begun.

2.4. BOT UNSTUCK RULE

2.4.1. Each bot is allowed one release during the match; this means if your bot is stuck on the floor or under an arena rail, the referee will stop the match, release the bot without changing its position, and then restart the match.

2.4.1.1. Being tossed out of the arena (i.e., over the rail, up on the rail or wall, or between the rail and wall) or knocked upside down does not constitute being stuck.

2.4.1.2. Each robot is also allowed one flip (the referee will pause the match and flip the robot over) during each match. This must be called by the team and can be called at any time.

2.4.1.3. Multi-bots are allowed one release total, not one release for each bot.

2.4.2. If both competing teams' bots are stuck on each other, they will be released as often as needed without changing the bots' positions.

2.4.3. The match and the clock will be paused to allow the referee to bot(s) to be unstuck.

2.4.4. Drivers are to hold the remotes away from their bodies during the pause until the referee restarts the match."

2.5. BOT PINNING

2.5.1. If a bot pins or traps the other bot, they must release it after the referee counts 10 seconds.

2.5.2. bot UNABLE TO MOVE

2.5.2.1. If a bot is unable to move during the match, the referee will start a 10-second countdown. If that bot cannot move by the end of the countdown, it will be considered a "Knockout" or a loss, and the other bot will be the winner of the match. The referee will decide whether the bot shows sufficient movement. In the case of Multi-bots, this is true if it is the “primary” bot. If it is not the “primary” bot, the match continues, and there is no countdown. If both bots are unable to move after the 10-second countdown, the judges will determine the winner of the match.

2.5.3. SUFFICIENT MOVEMENT

2.5.3.1. Any movement from the robot as a whole is sufficient movement (translational or spinning). Wheels from the robot spinning, but not providing movement to the overall robot, does not count as sufficient movement.

2.6. BOT STACKING

2.6.1. If a bot, for any reason, is unable to move due to it being oriented in such a way that its means of translational movement is not in contact with the floor, the bot shall be considered “stacked”. This does not count as bots being stuck and does not allow for a bot to be unstuck.

2.6.1.1. Examples are the following:

2.6.1.1.1. A bot that is leaning against or on an arena wall or railing, but not held in place by the arena.

2.6.1.1.2. A bot that is high-centered on a piece of debris from either bot that does not constitute an entanglement device.

2.7. POSTPONEMENTS

2.7.1. At the referee’s discretion, some leeway will be given at the beginning of the match to troubleshoot transmitter/receiver linking issues.

2.7.2. Postponements may be allowed at the discretion of the event organizer.

2.7.3. There is no established set time between matches; however, each team will be allowed at least 20 minutes between matches to complete repairs if needed.

2.7.4. An AWT official will inform someone in your pit area about your scheduled matches. Please have someone present in your pit area to be notified. Failure to be available could cause your team to forfeit.

2.7.5. If agreed by the event organizer, referee, and the opposing team, the team needing more time to get their bot in working order may be granted additional time before their match starts.

2.8. TAP OUT

2.8.1. If a team wishes to stop the match at any time, they may loudly declare “Tap Out" and/or sound the air horn. This will be an automatic loss for that team.

2.8.2. The referee will immediately stop the match. The other team will not be allowed to attack them after they have declared a “Tap Out.”

2.8.3. If a team deliberately hits a team’s bot who has tapped out, they will be issued a warning per section 2.11 of the Technical Regulations.

2.9. JUDGING

2.9.1. If a match goes the full time allotted to the match and both robots are still functional and have not been counted out, tapped out, or knocked out, then the decision of the winner goes to the judges. All judges' decisions are final. See Judging Criteria for additional information.

2.10. SHOW MOTION

2.10.1. If at the end of a match one or both robots have lost/ received damage to their ability to move and or use their weapon, the judges can ask for the robots to "show motion" (show the ability of motion and weapon use). This information will help the judges score the match. To be used in close fights.

3.BOT DEACTIVATION & LOAD OUT STEPS

3.1. LOAD OUT STEPS

3.1.1. The Driver holds the bot’s transmitter with the controls facing away from their body.

3.1.2. One teammate enters the combat arena to disable the weapon system. This includes any applicable weapon locks, power cutoff, and venting. The exact order of this procedure will be left to the discretion of the builder, as differing designs may necessitate different safe shutdown procedures.

3.1.3. The Main power is turned off on the bot.

3.1.4. The Transmitter is turned off by the Driver outside of the combat arena.

3.1.5. Weapon covers and safety guards are reinstalled.

3.1.6. If the robot is able to be removed from the arena without assistance, it may be removed at this time; otherwise, bots will be removed from the arena once all bots have had their weapon locks installed and are powered down.

4.EMERGENCY DEACTIVATION PROCEDURE

4.1. In the event of an emergency (for example, one or more bots are on fire), the standard procedure does not apply. The following attempts to address the vast majority of possible situations that are likely to occur.

4.2. One bot is burning, and the other is mobile:

4.2.1. The mobile bot is to move to the wall furthest from the arena entry door and align its drive wheels parallel with the wall. If the bot has an active weapon, it is to immediately begin dissipating stored energy (spinning down, releasing for spring-actuated weapons, etc) and, if possible, bring it next to or into contact with the wall it is aimed at.

4.2.2. Once the working bot is in position, the referee and a safety inspector will enter the arena and extinguish the fire, then, if possible, remove the bot from the arena.

4.2.3. The operator of the non-burning bot may then proceed with normal load-out procedures once the referee and safety inspector indicate that it is safe to enter the arena.

4.2.4. If there is still time on the clock for the match when the robot is on fire, then the robot on fire automatically receives the loss for the match.

4.3. One bot is burning, and the other is immobile:

4.3.1. If the immobile bot has an active weapon, it is to immediately begin dissipating stored energy. (spinning down, release for spring-actuated weapons, etc) If the bot retains some degree of mobility but cannot move reliably, it will attempt to angle itself such that any weapons are aimed at the wall furthest from the arena entry door.

4.3.2. Once the arena is able to be entered safely, the referee and a safety inspector will enter the arena and extinguish the fire, then, if possible, remove the bot from the arena.

4.3.3. The operator of the non-burning bot may then proceed with normal load-out procedures.

4.3.4. With one bot on fire and the other immobile, the match will be decided by the judges.

4.4. Both bots are burning:

4.4.1. Both bots will, if applicable, immediately attempt to dissipate any stored energy systems and will attempt no other actions.

4.4.2. Once the arena is able to be entered safely, the referee and a safety inspector will enter the arena and extinguish the fire, then, if possible, remove both bots from the arena.

4.4.3. With both bots burning, the match will be decided by the judges.

4.5. One or more bots are burning during a rumble:

4.5.1. All mobile, non-burning bots will move to the closest arena wall that is not used to access the arena and begin dissipating stored energy.

4.5.2. All immobile bots will immediately begin dissipating stored energy and will perform no other actions unless they can rotate such that they can angle any weapon systems at the wall furthest from the arena entry door.

4.5.3. Once the arena is able to be entered safely, the referee and a safety inspector will enter the arena and extinguish the fire, then, if possible, remove the bot from the arena.

4.5.4. If there is time left, the match will be allowed to resume.

5.EMERGENCY MATCH STOPPAGE PROCEDURE

5.1. In the event of an exposed bot battery, an arena breach, damage to the arena that renders it unsafe, or any other event that is otherwise deemed a safety risk by the referee, judges, or event staff, the match shall immediately be halted.

5.2. An exposed battery during the match will result in the match being paused and considered an automatic knockout.

5.3. It is the responsibility of the team to ensure that the driver or another team member is watching and/or listening to the instructions of the referee.

5.4. If a competitor continues to fight after the referee has called for the fight to be stopped, they will be disqualified. Repeated infractions will result in removal from the tournament. It is the responsibility of the driver to ensure that they respond promptly to the call to stop fighting.

5.5. Once fighting has ceased, the bots will be deactivated. The deactivated bots may be left in place or moved to a safe location in or around the arena until a determination about the status of the fight is made. No work may be done on the bots during this time. The source of the safety issue will then be inspected to determine the appropriate action. Once the issue has been resolved, a determination will be made as to whether or not the fight will resume. If possible, the fight will resume from the point where it was paused. If resuming the fight is determined not to be possible due to a safety concern or other issue, the fight will be judged up until the point where it was stopped.